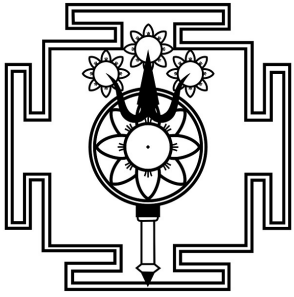
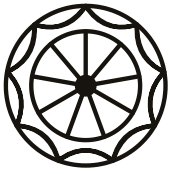
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TANTRIC PRAYER

Thirty-Six Prayers for the Inner Weather

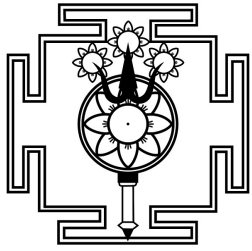




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TANTRIC PRAYER

Thirty-Six Prayers for the Inner Weather



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THE UN-DRUNK ONE'S THIRST

भवद्भक्त्यमृतास्वादाद् बोधस्य स्यात् परापि या / दशा सा मां प्रति स्वामिन् नासवस्येव शुक्तता

bhavadbhaktyamṛtāsvādād bodhasya syāt parāpi yā / daśā sā māṃ prati svāmin nāsavasyeva śuktatā

may the higher knowledge come from tasting the nectar of your devotion —
that state, lord, turn toward me,
keen as the not-yet-drunk one's thirst for the first drink.

The Un-Drunk One's Thirst

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 1.11 · 1.11

The poem does not shame longing.

WHAT IS IT

The poem does not shame longing. It asks that devotion, rather than possession, become the taste of longing

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When longing is loud: say the verse and let the object of the longing become the taste of devotion rather than the thing you'd grab.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Do the next honest thing about the desire; pursue or decline it without making the outcome a spiritual verdict.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

keep the ache — it is the rasa before it arrives; the thirst IS the practice.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 1.11

क्षणम् अपीह न तावकदासतां प्रति भवेयम् अहं किल भाजनम् / भवदभेदरसासवम् आदराद् अविरतं रसयेयम् अहं न चेत्

kṣaṇam apīha na tāvakadāsatāṃ prati bhaveyam ahaṃ kila bhājanam / bhavadabhedarasāsavam ādarād avirataṃ rasayeyam ahaṃ na cet

let me not spend one moment here as anything
other than your servant's vessel — one who reverently,
unceasingly drinks the rasa-wine of your non-difference.

The Wine of Non-Difference

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 4.18 · 4.18

In the poem, separation becomes a longing for a beloved who is also the ground of experience.

WHAT IS IT

In the poem, separation becomes a longing for a beloved who is also the ground of experience. The longing remains intelligible; metaphysical unity is its contemplative horizon

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When you crave closeness to something: say it and re-cast — the wine is already poured (non-difference); you are the cup.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Send the message, hold the boundary, or simply carry on without testing whether you feel united.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

warmth as if from a sip; the distance you wanted to close was the fiction.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 4.18

अम्बुदैः शिखिगणो विनाद्यते का रतिः प्रिय मया विनाद्य ते

ambudaiḥ śikhigaṇo vinādyate kā ratiḥ priya mayā vinādya te

by clouds the peacock-flock is sounded —
what delight, beloved, without me today?

What Delight, Beloved

KṢEMARĀJA, GHATAKARPARA (POT-SHERDS) V.5 · GHAT-P01 V5

The landscape can carry longing without making every cry your private catastrophe.

WHAT IS IT

The landscape can carry longing without making every cry your private catastrophe. This is aesthetic evocation; a Śaiva devotional adaptation is editorial, not the poem's proven genre

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When longing for someone or something: say it as the peacock line — the cry is appropriate, beautiful, and will end with the rain. Feel the ache as weather: you are the bird, not the drowning.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Return to the real person or the weather; neither must answer you.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

FULL; no mantra claim

Source: L4-ghat-p01-v05.DRAFT.json · ghat-p01 v5

THE MOON THAT CARRIES THE NECTAR

प्रकाशां शीतलाम्
एकां शुद्धां
शशिकलाम् इव /
दृशं वितर मे नाथ
काम् अप्य्
अमृतवाहिनीम्

prakāśāṃ śītalām ekāṃ śuddhāṃ śaśikalām iva / dṛśaṃ vitara me nātha kām apy amṛtavāhinīm

give me one glance of yours — light, cool, pure,
like the moon's crescent, carrying nectar —

o lord, for my desire itself.

The Moon That Carries the Nectar

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 3.5 · 3.5

The devotee does not command desire to disappear; the beloved is asked to illuminate it with tenderness.

WHAT IS IT

The devotee does not command desire to disappear; the beloved is asked to illuminate it with tenderness

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When desire runs hot: one breath in, offer the heat upward as the thing that needs the glance, and picture the crescent-cool gaze landing on it. The prayer cools by image, not by prohibition.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Respond to the actual need calmly; desire may remain.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the heat stays but stops being an emergency.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 3.5

HĀSYA

LAUGHING, DANCING, EATING IT ALL

हस्यते नृत्यते यत्र रागद्वेषादि भुज्यते / पीयते भक्तिपीयूषरसस् तत् प्राप्नुयां पदम्

hasyate nṛtyate yatra rāgadveṣādi bhujyate / pīyate bhaktipīyūṣarasas tat prāpnuyāṃ padam

where he laughs and dances, where desire and hatred themselves are eaten,
where the nectar-rasa of devotion is drunk —

may i attain that state.

Laughing, Dancing, Eating It All

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 5.18 · 5.18

The surprise is not that anger is fake; the poem pictures a freedom expansive enough not to be monopolised by aversion.

WHAT IS IT

The surprise is not that anger is fake; the poem pictures a freedom expansive enough not to be monopolised by aversion

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Say it when something finally stops being infuriating — and notice the laugh that arrives is the verse working.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Laugh if laughter comes; otherwise continue without forcing cheer.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the annoyance is suddenly chewable; that is bhujyate happening. Let the laugh be the proof.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 5.18

उपहासैकसारे ऽस्मिन्न् एतावति जगत्त्रये / तुभ्यम् एवाद्वितीयाय नमो नित्यसुखासिने

upahāsaikasāre 'sminn etāvati jagattraye / tubhyam evādvitīyāya namo nityasukhāsine

in this three-world joke whose essence is laughter —
to you alone, the non-dual, the one seated in eternal joy:
namas.

The Essence of Laughter

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 2.18 · 2.18

Humour and reverence can coexist.

WHAT IS IT

Humour and reverence can coexist. This is an interpretation of a hymn, not evidence that every painful event is deliberately comic

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When life turns absurd: say it, and read the absurdity as his seat.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Repair what can be repaired, especially if another person is affected.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

irreverence without disrespect — the sigh turns into a chuckle, and the chuckle lands on him.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 2.18

जयन्ति ते जगद्वन्द्या दासास् ते जगतां विभो / संसारार्णव एवैष येषां क्रीडामहासरः

jayanti te jagadvandyā dāsās te jagatāṃ vibho / saṃsārārṇava evaiṣa yeṣāṃ krīḍāmahāsaraḥ

victorious are your servants, lord of the worlds —
for whom this ocean of saṃsāra
is a laughing-play.

His Laughing-Play

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 3.15 · 3.15

The circumstances are not denied: what changes in the poem is the relation of the devotee to the frightening immensity.

WHAT IS IT

The circumstances are not denied: what changes in the poem is the relation of the devotee to the frightening immensity

HOW TO PERFORM IT

In a hard moment, name it: ocean. Then say the verse, and the water becomes shallow.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Choose one manageable task; amusement is optional.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the shoulders drop and the mouth lifts before the situation changes at all.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 3.15

ANGRY, THEN LAUGHING, THEN ŚIVA

भक्तिक्षीवो ऽपि कुप्येयं भवायानुशयीय च / तथा हसेयं उद्यां च रटेयं च शिवेत्य् अलम्

bhaktikṣīvo 'pi kupyeyaṃ bhavāyānuśayīya ca / tathā haseyaṃ udyāṃ ca raṭeyaṃ ca śivety alam

let me be drunk on devotion — and angry with the world,
and pitying it — then laugh, and rise up, and shout:

śiva! — enough.

Angry, Then Laughing, Then Śiva

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 16.7 · 16.7

The verse permits devotion to accompany contradictory emotions.

WHAT IS IT

The verse permits devotion to accompany contradictory emotions. It need not be a manual for escalating or discharging anger

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When worked up: say it as an instruction manual — drunk first, then let it become laugh, rise, and shout. The last word must be Śiva, out loud if you dare.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Do not send the harmful message; act on the issue when you can do so without cruelty.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the anger doesn't get suppressed; it gets promoted.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 16.7

THE SEED OF SORROW

चित्रं निसर्गतो नाथ
दुःखबीजम् इदं मनः
/
त्वद्भक्तिरससंसिक्तम्
निःश्रेयसमहाफलम्

citraṃ nisargato nātha duḥkhabījam idaṃ manaḥ /
tvadbhaktirasasaṃsiktam niḥśreyasamahāphalam

strange, lord: this mind is by nature the seed of sorrow —
yet watered with the rasa of your devotion
it ripens into the highest fruit.

The Seed of Sorrow

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 1.26 · 1.26

The poem imagines that a mind carrying sorrow may also carry devotion.

WHAT IS IT

The poem imagines that a mind carrying sorrow may also carry devotion. Grief is not a mistake that must disappear before worship begins

HOW TO PERFORM IT

In grief: say it and water the seed instead of cursing the soil.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Care for yourself or someone else in one concrete way.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the grief stays, but it is being used; even the tears count as irrigation.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 1.26

THE FLOOD OVER JOY AND SORROW

हर्षाणाम् अथ शोकानां सर्वेषां प्लावकः समम् / भवद्ध्यानामृतापूरो निम्नाणिम्नभुवाम् इव

harṣāṇām atha śokānāṃ sarveṣāṃ plāvakaḥ samam /
bhavaddhyānāmṛtāpūro nimnāṇimnabhuvām iva

the flood of nectar from meditating you overflows
joy and sorrow alike — like waters filling
all the low and lower lands.

The Flood Over Joy and Sorrow

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 3.9 · 3.9

Devotion is represented as a fullness not rationed according to the quality of one's present emotion.

WHAT IS IT

Devotion is represented as a fullness not rationed according to the quality of one's present emotion

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Say it in either state — grief or glee — the verse works on the level of the field, not the feeling.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Make room for the feeling; if support is needed, ask for it.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

a settling, as if water found its level; the ranking of emotions collapses.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 3.9

SORROW MIXED WITH GHEE

देव दुःखान्य् अशेषाणि यानि संसारिणाम् अपि / घृत्याख्यभवदीयात्म युतान्य् आयान्ति सह्यताम्

deva duḥkhāny aśeṣāṇi yāni saṃsāriṇām api /
ghṛtyākhyabhavadīyātmayutāny āyānti sahyatām

lord, the countless sorrows even of the world-dweller —
mixed with your own self they become ghee:

they come to be bearable.

Sorrow Mixed with Ghee

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 10.16 · 10.16

The devotional possibility is to include suffering in one's address to Śiva without claiming that suffering becomes pleasant.

WHAT IS IT

The devotional possibility is to include suffering in one's address to Śiva without claiming that suffering becomes pleasant

HOW TO PERFORM IT

In pain: say the ghee line and literally imagine the sharp edge of the feeling being coated.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Use appropriate medical, emotional or practical care as needed.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the body responds to texture, not to reasons — the tightness loosens because the sharpness is now suspended.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 10.16

THE BANNER AGAINST SUFFERING

हे नाथ प्रणतार्तिनाशनपटो
श्रेयोनिधे धूर्जटे दुःखैकायतनस्य
जन्ममरणत्रस्तस्य मे साम्प्रतम् /
तच् चेष्टस्व यथा
मनोज्ञविषयास्वादप्रदा उत्तमा
जीवन्न् एव समश्नुवे ऽहम् अचलाः
सिद्धीस् त्वदर्चापरः

he nātha praṇatārtināśanapaṭo śreyonidhe dhūrjaṭe
duḥkhaikāyatanasya janmamaraṇatrastasya me sāmpratam / tac
ceṣṭasva yathā manojñaviṣayāsvādapradā uttamā jīvann eva samaśnuve
'ham acalāḥ siddhīs tvadarcāparaḥ

o lord, the banner that destroys the suffering of the bowing —
treasure of good, dhūrjaṭa: for me whose only home is sorrow,
afraid of birth and death — so act for me, that while yet living
i may enjoy the sweet taste of the good sense-objects,
unshakeable, the powers in service of your worship.

The Banner Against Suffering

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 11.14 · 11.14

An address to the Lord need not wait for a persuasive argument or a purified mood.

WHAT IS IT

An address to the Lord need not wait for a persuasive argument or a purified mood

HOW TO PERFORM IT

At 3am in the pit: say the whole confession first, then the name.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Rest, talk to someone, or carry out the next necessary step.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the banner is real — a flag planted IN the grief, not flying over it. The fear of birth and death can be said out loud; that's the verse's permission.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 11.14

THE AXE OF 'ALL IS HIS'

एतन् मम न त्व् इदम् इति रागद्वेषादिनिगडदृढमूले / नाथ भवन्मयतैक्यप्रत्ययपर शुः पतत्वन्तः

etan mama na tv idam iti rāgadveṣādinigaḍadṛḍhamūle / nātha bhavanmayataikyapratyayaparaśuḥ patatvantaḥ

'this is mine, this is not yours' — the roots of attachment and aversion, hard-shackled;
o lord, let the axe of the one conviction 'all is your-become' fall on them in me.

The Axe of 'All Is His'

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 7.2 · 7.2

The poem exposes the division enacted by possessiveness; this is contemplation, not an instruction to abandon legitimate boundaries.

WHAT IS IT

The poem exposes the division enacted by possessiveness; this is contemplation, not an instruction to abandon legitimate boundaries

HOW TO PERFORM IT

In rage: name the possession first — 'mine', 'not yours' — then say the verse at it.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Keep the boundary if needed, but leave out the contempt.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the fist unclenches not by relaxing but by losing the ownership record; the thing remains, the claiming ends.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 7.2

LET THE ANGER RIPEN

मानावमानरागादिनिष्पाकविमलं मनः / यस्यासौ भक्तिमांल् लोकतुल्यशीलः कथं भवेत्

mānāvamānarāgādiniṣpākavimalaṃ manaḥ / yasyāsau bhaktimāṃl lokatulyaśīlaḥ kathaṃ bhavet

the mind purified by the complete ripening of
honour and dishonour, rāga and the rest —
such a devotee: how could he have ordinary-world conduct?

Let the Anger Ripen

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 16.15 · 16.15

The devotee can learn to take praise and insult as circumstances, not final definitions of the Self.

WHAT IS IT

The devotee can learn to take praise and insult as circumstances, not final definitions of the Self

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When slighted: say it and let the feeling ripen rather than react — the insult is being cooked, not served.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Accept valid feedback; decline the unjust portion; answer without vengeance.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the heat continues but stops being an instruction to act.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 16.15

DEVOTION CONQUERS THE DARKNESS

रागद्वेषन्धकारो ऽपि येषां भक्तित्विषा जितः / तेषां महीयसाम् अग्रे कतमे ज्ञानशालिनः

rāgadveṣandhakāro 'pi yeṣāṃ bhaktitviṣā jitaḥ / teṣāṃ mahīyasām agre katame jñānaśālinaḥ

in whose case even the darkness of attachment and aversion
has been conquered by the brilliance of devotion —
what to speak of the learned, among such exalted ones?

Devotion Conquers the Darkness

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 16.16 · 16.16

The hymn places aversion within a wider account of devotion; it does not excuse harm or require instant forgiveness.

WHAT IS IT

The hymn places aversion within a wider account of devotion; it does not excuse harm or require instant forgiveness

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Say it as a light-switch claim: the anger is dark, and you are switching on devotion rather than wrestling the dark.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Set down the rehearsal for now; make any needed repair or protection.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

warmth precedes relief — that order is the physics.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 16.16

वन्द्यास् ते ऽपि महीयांसः प्रलयोपगता अपि / त्वत्कोपपावकस्पर्शपू ता ये परमेश्वर

vandyās te 'pi mahīyāṃsaḥ pralayopagatā api /
tvatkopapāvakasparśapūtā ye parameśvara

also worthy of praise, O supreme, are those
made pure by the touch of your wrath's fire
even when you have destroyed them.

Your Wrath Purifies

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 10.20 · 10.20

Devotional literature can address a Lord who is not a sentimental comfort.

WHAT IS IT

Devotional literature can address a Lord who is not a sentimental comfort. Praise can remain demanding and difficult

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When caught in a rage — yours or someone's: say it, and re-classify the fire as purifying touch before responding.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Be truthful about what happened; seek safety if there is danger.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the flinch converts to a bow.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 10.20

VICTORY — THE WORLD DEPENDS ON HIM

जय देव नमो नमो ऽस्तु ते सकलं विश्वम् इदं तवाश्रितम् / जगतां परमेश्वरो भवान् परमेकः शरणागतो ऽस्मि ते

jaya deva namo namo 'stu te sakalaṃ viśvam idaṃ tavāśritam / jagatāṃ parameśvaro bhavān paramekaḥ śaraṇāgato 'smi te

victory, lord — namas, namas to you:
this entire universe depends on you;
you are the supreme lord of the worlds, the one —
in you alone i take refuge.

Victory — the World Depends on Him

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 2.29 · 2.29

The hymn directs triumph toward Śiva.

WHAT IS IT

The hymn directs triumph toward Śiva. Courage can mean acting without owning the victory

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Morning, before the task: say it once under the breath, fast.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Start the difficult task; let the result remain open.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the chest widens; effort turns from strain into celebration because the weight is his, not yours.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 2.29

अन्तर्भक्तिचमत्कारचर्वणामीलितेक्षणः / नमो मह्यं शिवायेति पूजयम् स्यां तृणान्य् अपि

antarbhakticamatkāracarvaṇāmīlitekṣaṇaḥ / namo mahyaṃ śivāyeti pūjayam syāṃ tṛṇāny api

when, eyes closed in the tasting of inner devotion-wonder,
i worship 'namas to śiva' —
may i become even the grass [in that place].

May I Become the Grass

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 5.15 · 5.15

The heroic gesture here may be relinquishing the need to appear heroic.

WHAT IS IT

The heroic gesture here may be relinquishing the need to appear heroic

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When enthusiasm needs depth rather than noise: say it and offer to be the least impressive thing in the room.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Do the work that actually needs doing.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the wanting-to-be-seen dissolves; the energy continues without the vanity.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 5.15

THE SOUND THAT NEVER LEAVES THE MOUTH

ते जयन्ति मुखमण्डले भ्रमन् अस्ति येषु नियतं शिवध्वनिः / यः शाशीव प्रसृतो ऽमृताशयात् स्वादु संस्रवति चामृतं परम्

te jayanti mukhamaṇḍale bhraman asti yeṣu niyataṃ śivadhvaniḥ / yaḥ śāśīva prasṛto 'mṛtāśayāt svādu saṃsravati cāmṛtaṃ param

victorious those on whose mouth's circle
the sound of śiva constantly roams —
ever-streaming from the immortal reservoir,
the supreme nectar dripping sweet.

The Sound That Never Leaves the Mouth

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 4.14 · 4.14

A small act of remembrance can accompany demanding activity without claiming to control its outcome.

WHAT IS IT

A small act of remembrance can accompany demanding activity without claiming to control its outcome

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Say it when you catch the name rising on its own — mid-shower, mid-walk. The verse applauds the practice applauding itself.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Speak or act as carefully as the occasion requires.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

pride WITH devotion; the discipline patting itself on the back.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 4.14

PRAISED BECAUSE YOU WORSHIP

चपलम् असि यद् अपि मानस तत्रापि श्लाघ्यसे यतो भजसे / शरणानाम् अपि शरणं त्रिभुवनगुरुम् अम्बिकाकान्तम्

capalam asi yad api mānasa tatrāpi ślāghyase yato bhajase / śaraṇānām api śaraṇaṃ tribhuvanagurum ambikākāntam

o mind, though you are flickering, yet you are praised —
because you worship:
you take refuge in the refuge of the refuges,
the teacher of the three worlds, the beloved of ambikā.

Praised Because You Worship

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 4.1 · 4.1

Rather than hating an unsettled mind, the devotee recognises the possibility of worship within it.

WHAT IS IT

Rather than hating an unsettled mind, the devotee recognises the possibility of worship within it

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Address it TO your mind, in the second person, when it won't hold — praise it for showing up rather than scolding it for drifting.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Return to one defined action; attention may wander again.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

self-compassion as fuel; the scattered mind sits down when praised, not when punished.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 4.1

WHEN WILL I SUDDENLY RECOGNISE YOU

ईश्वरम् अभयम् उदारं पूर्णम् अकारणम् अपह्नुतात्मानं / सहसाभिज्ञाय कदा स्वामिजनं लज्जयिष्यामि

īśvaram abhayam udāraṃ pūrṇam akāraṇam apahnutātmānaṃ / sahasābhijñāya kadā svāmijanaṃ lajjayiṣyāmi

the lord — fearless, generous, full, causeless,
beyond denial of self — when will i suddenly recognise him —
and put the master's own folk to shame?

When Will I Suddenly Recognise You

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 9.6 · 9.6

The text offers refuge in what the devotee takes to be unconditioned.

WHAT IS IT

The text offers refuge in what the devotee takes to be unconditioned. It does not make danger imaginary

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When fear is up: say it as a question, not a plea — kadā? when?.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Check actual risks and take proportionate action.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

fear becomes the sound before the recognition rather than the enemy of it. After the last word, expect nothing; the asking is the turning.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 9.6

मूढो ऽस्मि दुःखकलितो ऽस्मि जरादिदोषभीतो ऽस्मि शक्तिरहितो ऽस्मि तवाश्रितो ऽस्मि / शम्भो तथा कलय शीघ्रम् उपैमि येन सर्वोत्तमां धुरम् अपोज्झितदुःखमार्गः

mūḍho 'smi duḥkhakalito 'smi jarādidoṣabhīto 'smi śaktirahito 'smi tavāśrito 'smi / śambho tathā kalaya śīghram upaimi yena sarvottamāṃ dhuram apojjhitaduḥkhamārgaḥ

i am dull, i am weighed with sorrow, i am afraid of old age's flaws,
i am without power — i have taken refuge in you, o śambhu;
so calculate what's left.

The Full Confession

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 11.8 · 11.8

The devotional address begins with the admitted state, not its elimination.

WHAT IS IT

The devotional address begins with the admitted state, not its elimination

HOW TO PERFORM IT

List YOUR four in his cadence, then land the last line.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Tell someone if help is needed; do not use the prayer instead of safety.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the inventory leaves the body lighter; the refuge-line is the exhale. Especially for aging-anxiety and inadequacy-shame.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 11.8

THE AGHORA MANTRA

अघोरेभ्यो ऽथ घोरेभ्यो घोरघोरतरीभ्यश्च । सर्वतः शर्व सर्वेभ्यो नमस्ते रुद्ररूपेभ्यः ॥

aghorebhyo 'tha ghorebhyo ghoraghoratarībhyaśca | sarvataḥ śarva sarvebhyo namaste rudrarūpebhyaḥ ||

salutations to aghora, to ghora, to ghoraghora-tarī — to sarva in all directions, to all the rudra-forms: namas.

The Aghora Mantra

YAJURVEDA · CHANTED BY SWAMI LAKSHMANJOO AT EVERY WEEKLY SANGHA · SECRET SUPREME CH.13 · LETTER 1989

The invocation addresses fierce and non-fierce forms alike.

WHAT IS IT

The invocation addresses fierce and non-fierce forms alike. Its devotional move is salutation, not magic protection against all danger

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Chant it where Swamiji put it: at the opening of any practice — this is the beginning of the Weekly Sangha. Three to nine rounds, aloud. When to: first thing in the morning, or at any moment of fear — you are addressing the three energies directly. Effect, per the tradition he taught: protection through the eighteen arms and purification of the three channels, body, speech and mind. His own instruction for its spread: 'You should spread this message all over the world.'

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Check your surroundings and do what the situation requires.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

FULL MANTRA; do not excerpt an invented bīja

Source: efficacy-aghora.pdf · Secret Supreme ch.13 · letter 1989

THE SCORCHING DISSOLVED

लब्धाणिमादिसिद्धिर् विगलितसकलोपता पसन्त्रासः / त्वद्भक्तिरसायनपान क्रिढानिष्टः कदासीय

labdhāṇimādisiddhir vigalitasakalopatāpasantrāsaḥ /
tvadbhaktirasāyanapānakriḍhāniṣṭaḥ kadāsīya

when will i come to dwell in the drinking-and-playing
of your devotion-nectar — with the eight powers attained,
and all fear of troubles dissolved?

The Scorching Dissolved

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 9.18 · 9.18

The verse's aspiration can be held without knowing when its desired state will come.

WHAT IS IT

The verse's aspiration can be held without knowing when its desired state will come

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Anxious about what's coming? Take the verse as a drink-description and sip your current state as rasa.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Return to a safe practical next step.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the anticipatory heat cools; the future stops glowing red.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 9.18

THE SMEAR THAT IS FORGETTING

अन्तर् अप्य् अतितराम् अणीयसी या त्वदप्रथनकालिकास्ति मे / ताम् अपीश परिमृज्य सर्वतः स्वं स्वरूपम् अमलं प्रकाशय

antar apy atitarām aṇīyasī yā tvadaprathanakālikāsti me / tām apīśa parimṛjya sarvataḥ svaṃ svarūpam amalaṃ prakāśaya

even within, the tiniest smear that is my non-
contemplation of you —
wiping that, o lord, from everywhere,

[show] your own form.

The Smear That Is Forgetting

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 13.2 · 13.2

The metaphor can open an honest act of repair; it should never amplify hatred of the body or self.

WHAT IS IT

The metaphor can open an honest act of repair; it should never amplify hatred of the body or self

HOW TO PERFORM IT

In self-loathing: rename the stain — it is just the lapse of attention. Wipe = return, not scrub.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Apologise or correct one thing; then stop rehearsing self-punishment.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the self-hatred loses its subject, and what's left is a fresh look at his form.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 13.2

मनसि मलिने मदीयेमग्ना त्वद्भक्तिमणिलता कष्टम् / न निजान् अपि तनुते तानपौरुषेयान् स्वसम्पदुल्लासान्

manasi maline madīyemagnā tvadbhaktimaṇilatā kaṣṭam / na nijān api tanute tānapauruṣeyān svasampadullāsān

in my mind, absolutely impure, my own devotion-vine
drowned —
hard: it ripens not even its own,
the unearned blossoms of its fortune.

The Impure Mind, Confessed

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 15.14 · 15.14

A relationship can be tended after neglect.

WHAT IS IT

A relationship can be tended after neglect. The image is about devotion, not proof that the reader is polluted

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Say it on the days you feel worst about yourself — the hymn says it for you, better.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Resume one sustainable practice or ordinary care.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

honesty displaces shame; the muck, spoken aloud, is at least seen.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 15.14

THE DOUBT-ENEMY SHATTERED

खरनिषेधखदामृतपूरणोच्छलितधौतविकल्पमलस्य मे / दलितदुर्जयसंशयवैरिणस् त्वदवलोकनम् अस्तु निरन्तरम्

kharaniṣedhakhadāmṛtapūraṇocchalitadhautavikalpamalasya me / dalitadurjayasaṃśayavairiṇas tvadavalokanam astu nirantaram

the thought-stain in my mind, scoured by the deathless nectar's flood
poured over the trough of refuse — with the invincible doubt-enemy crushed:
let beholding you be unceasing.

The Doubt-Enemy Shattered

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 18.19 · 18.19

Cleansing is a devotional metaphor; moral responsibility remains the appropriate ordinary response.

WHAT IS IT

Cleansing is a devotional metaphor; moral responsibility remains the appropriate ordinary response

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When the mind feels stained AND doubting: stop scrubbing, start looking — one look inward at the form.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Repair a harm where possible; otherwise rest from self-accusation.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

doubt and disgust fall together because they were both standing in the dark.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 18.19

STRIKE THE DIVIDING-PIECE

विलीने शङ्कौघे सपदि परिपूर्णे च विभवे । संहाराख्या मम हृदि भिदांशं प्रहरतु

vilīne śaṅkaughe sapadi paripūrṇe ca vibhave | saṃhārākhyā mama hṛdi bhidāṃśaṃ praharatu

in the melted doubt-heap, at once in full glory —
o lord named dissolution, strike the split portion of my heart.

Strike the Dividing-Piece

ABHINAVAGUPTA, KRAMASTOTRA 19.19 · KRAM-P19 V19

Its closing petition, if confirmed, addresses inner division without proving that doubt is literally annihilated.

WHAT IS IT

Its closing petition, if confirmed, addresses inner division without proving that doubt is literally annihilated

HOW TO PERFORM IT

After weeks of inner division — this vs that, me vs it: say it as the surgeon's request, once.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Do not confuse a powerful inward metaphor with permission to strike a person.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the split seals; the hunger to divide ends with the knife that isn't yours.

Source: L4-kram-p19.DRAFT.json · kram-p19 v19

THE WONDER OF THE WORD AT TONGUE-TIP

शिव इत्य् एकशब्दस्य जिह्वाग्रे तिष्ठतः सदा / समस्तविषयास्वादो भक्तेष्व् एवास्ति को ऽप्य् अहो

śiva ity ekaśabdasya jihvāgre tiṣṭhataḥ sadā / samastaviṣayāsvādo bhakteṣv evāsti ko 'py aho

when the single word śiva stands ever at the tongue's tip —

the taste of all sense-objects exists in the devotee alone.

what a wonder!

The Wonder of the Word at Tongue-Tip

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 1.20 · 1.20

Wonder can coexist with the simplest syllables.

WHAT IS IT

Wonder can coexist with the simplest syllables. The hymn is devotional praise, not a guaranteed transformation of taste

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When anything tastes or sounds flat: place Śiva at the tongue's tip and re-taste the next sip or bite.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Return to ordinary sensory attention.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the wonder is measurable — if the flavour deepens, the verse is real.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 1.20

मायाविने विशुद्धाय गुह्याय प्रकटात्मने / सूक्ष्माय विश्वरूपाय नमश् चित्राय शम्भवे

māyāvine viśuddhāya guhyāya prakaṭātmane / sūkṣmāya viśvarūpāya namaś citrāya śambhave

namas to the deceptive, the pure, the secret,
the manifest-self, the subtle, the all-form —
to the citra, to śambhu.

The Wonderful Deceiver

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 2.12 · 2.12

Language may point by holding together contrary aspects; the prose gloss should not pretend to solve each paradox.

WHAT IS IT

Language may point by holding together contrary aspects; the prose gloss should not pretend to solve each paradox

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When the world turns surreal — say the verse and file the strangeness under citra.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Let the situation remain complex and respond accurately.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the uncanny flips from threat to artistry; the trick becomes someone's excellent work.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 2.12

य एष विततस्फुरद्विविधभावचक्रात्मकः परस्परविभेदवान्विषयतामुपागच्छति यदेकमयभावनावशात एत्यभेदान्वयं स शंभुरशिवापहो जयति बोधभासां निधिः

ya eṣa vitatasphuradvividhabhāvacakrātmakaḥ parasparavibhedavānviṣayatāmupāgacchati yadekamayabhāvanāvaśata etyabhedānvayaṃ sa śaṃbhuraśivāpaho jayati bodhabhāsāṃ nidhiḥ

he who, made of the widely flashing wheel of diverse states, comes to be the objects of experience — whose one, given to

contemplation, is the bond of non-difference: he, śaṃbhu, averter of woe, triumphs — treasury of the lights of knowing.

The Wheel of Diverse States

ABHINAVAGUPTA, GĪTĀRTHASAṄGRAHA V.1 · GITA-A00 V1

The proposed thought is a single luminous reality appearing as difference, not an assertion that differences are fictitious for ordinary purposes.

WHAT IS IT

The proposed thought is a single luminous reality appearing as difference, not an assertion that differences are fictitious for ordinary purposes

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Use it as the invocation before any prayer-session in this book: name the swirl of your current states as the wheel, then remember the wheel IS the treasury.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Return attention to one particular thing in the varied world.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the chaos of feelings gets reclassified as treasure on sight.

Source: L4-gita-a00-v01.DRAFT.json · gita-a00 v1

अहो भक्तिभरोदारचेतसां वरद त्वयि / श्लाघ्यः पूजाविधिः को ऽपि यो न याच्ञाकलंकितः

aho bhaktibharodāracetasāṃ varada tvayi / slāghyaḥ pūjāvidhiḥ ko 'pi yo na yācñākalaṃkitaḥ

wonder! o boon-giver: among the full-hearted in devotion
toward you,
is any mode of worship praised
that is not stained with begging?

Worship Without Begging

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 17.24 · 17.24

Astonishment may not need elaborate ritual.

WHAT IS IT

Astonishment may not need elaborate ritual. The poem asks the question rather than prescribing a technique

HOW TO PERFORM IT

Notice when you've prayed with a shopping list. Say this verse as the correction, then worship once with nothing attached.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Notice the particular beauty; continue your day.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the ask drops and the song stays — that gap is the wonder.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 17.24

THE RASA BEYOND THE WORLD

शान्तकल्लोलशीताच्छस्वादुभक्तिसुधाम्बुधौ / अलौकिकरसास्वादे सुस्थैः को ऽनाम गण्यते

śāntakallolaśītācchasvādubhaktisudhāmbudhau / alaukikarasāsvāde susthaiḥ ko 'nāma gaṇyate

diving in the ocean of devotion's nectar — with peaceful waves, cool and white and sweet — tasting the alaukika rasa:

who among the steady even counts a name there?

The Rasa Beyond the World

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 1.21 · 1.21

The verse praises a devotional fullness in which stillness is welcomed rather than manufactured.

WHAT IS IT

The verse praises a devotional fullness in which stillness is welcomed rather than manufactured

HOW TO PERFORM IT

For peace-practice: dive once, taste once, count nothing — not even the breath.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Rest or work quietly; do not measure progress by calm.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the mental to-do list stops being readable; that illegibility is the alaukika flicker.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 1.21

ALL TIME IN THE WORSHIP-UNION

भवत्पूजामयासङ्गःसम्भोगसुखिनो मम / प्रयातु कालः सकलोऽप्य् अनन्तोऽपीयदर्थये

bhavatpūjāmayāsaṅgasambhogasukhino mama / prayātu kālaḥ sakalo 'py ananto 'pīyadarthaye

may all my time — even the endless kind — pass
in the happiness of union with your worship;
that alone is what i crave.

All Time in the Worship-Union

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 17.12 · 17.12

The wish is not that ordinary time vanish, but that devotion accompany time as it passes.

WHAT IS IT

The wish is not that ordinary time vanish, but that devotion accompany time as it passes

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When the day stretches ahead daunting: pray the WHOLE day into the worship-frame, then do the next ordinary thing as its first item.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Use the next minute for the duty in front of you.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the horizon softens; time becomes a room, not a corridor.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 17.12

FOR PEACE, NOT FOR PLEASURE

शान्तये न सुखलिप्सुता
मनाग् भक्तिसम्भृतमदेषु
तैः प्रभोः /
मोक्षमार्गणफलापि
नार्थना स्मर्यते
हृदयहारिणः पुरः

śāntaye na sukhalipsutā manāg bhaktisambhṛtamadeṣu taiḥ prabhoḥ /
mokṣamārgaṇaphalāpi nārthanā smaryate hṛdayahāriṇaḥ puraḥ

for peace, not for pleasure-seeking — those intoxicated
with the fullness of your devotion, o lord;
even the fruit of searching for liberation they don't crave —
before you, the heart-stealer.

For Peace, Not for Pleasure

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 18.15 · 18.15

The poem's fullness is not proof that a person should be tranquil under harm.

WHAT IS IT

The poem's fullness is not proof that a person should be tranquil under harm

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When peace turns into another acquisition-plan — this retreat, that technique, the next course — say it as the disarming.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Retain compassion and discernment; take practical action if needed.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the goal releases you; the practice continues unburdened.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 18.15

त्वत्कर्णदेशम धिशय्य महार्घभावम् आक्रन्दितानि मम तुच्छतराणि यान्ति / वंशान्तरालपतितानि जलैकदेशखण्डानि मौक्तिकमणित्वम् इवोद्वहन्ति

tvatkarṇadeśama dhiśayya mahārghabhāvam ākranditāni mama tucchatarāṇi yānti / vaṃśāntarālapatitāni jalaikadeśakhaṇḍāni mauktikamaṇitvam ivodvahanti

laying my cries at your ear's place, my dearest —
they grow small: like rain inside a bamboo-joint,
they rise as pearls.

Cries Like Bamboo-Drops

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 11.9 · 11.9

Devotion includes speech that is imperfect and fatigued.

WHAT IS IT

Devotion includes speech that is imperfect and fatigued. Silence may follow, but need not be engineered

HOW TO PERFORM IT

When crying or complaining: say it and consciously LAY the noise at his ear — the listener inside.

HOW TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

Return: Finish the prayer and move into a small ordinary kindness.

WHAT TO FEEL / VISUALISE

the sound gets smaller mid-sentence; the bamboo-joint is the quiet place behind your own listening.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 11.9

ॐ शान्तिः शान्तिः शान्तिः

TANTRIC PRAYER

COLOPHON

The prayers here are our own translations of the Sanskrit, checked line by line against the witnesses in our Kashmir Śaiva corpus (translation-work) — thirty-two from Utpaladeva's Śivastotrāvalī, plus Kṣemarāja's Ghatakarpara, Abhinavagupta's Kramastotra and Gītārthasaṅgraha. Each guide links its source file.

The rasa theory is Abhinavagupta's own — Abhinavabhāratī and Tantrāloka, quoted briefly and attributed; the references are flagged for verification against print editions. The three-layer naming follows Monier-Williams glosses and the conventional English rasa terms.

Swami Lakshmanjoo's material — the Aghora Mantra, its1989 letter, and the Śrī Bahurūpa-Garbha Stotra — is © the Hughes Family Trust, archived here and quoted briefly at his own instruction to "spread this message all over the world."

Set in Tiro Devanagari and Cormorant Garamond; A5; print-checked to the KDP paperback specification.

TANTRIC PRAYER · BUILT FROM TRANSLATION-WORK

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sources/L4-kram-p19.DRAFT.json
kram-p19 v19

L4 gita a00 v01.DRAFT.json
sources/L4-gita-a00-v01.DRAFT.json
gita-a00 v1

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